

Callous about it

To Digit,

There is a matter that I would like to bring to your notice. In December 1999, the Information Kerala Mission (IKM) formed by the government for computerisation of the local bodies in Kerala recruited Data Mechanic Trainees (DMTs), Technical Assistants, etc through a series of practical assessment tests and written tests. After a 17-day training session, which required us to give up our existing jobs, our services were utilised in the Panchayat-Nagarpalika Election 2000 for publication of results on the Internet. On July 1, 2001 the IKM issued us short-term termination order due to the non-availability of computers in local bodies even after a sanction of Rs 30 crore by the Planning Commission, Government of India. Having already lost our

previous jobs, we now find ourselves unemployed.

Despite the talk of an economic crisis, the computerisation of the Registration, Revenue and Secretariat departments has begun without completing the computerisation of local bodies, which is still in its first stage despite crores of Rupees being spent from the Union fund.

It is strange that while on one hand the Kerala government promises to bring the state to the forefront of Information Technology and provide jobs to 15 lakh youth in the state, on the other side 1,000 people have been rendered jobless. I think that the various parties are just using IT as a political ploy and hundreds of youth all over Kerala are paying the price.

RAJEEV P.

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Rajeev,

The governments of several states do seem to have gone overboard in their enthusiasm to promote IT. Each of them seems to be hell bent on making their own state the IT capital of India.

While this enthusiasm has resulted in progress being made by several states towards the much-touted goal of e-governance, many of these projects are doomed, at least in part, by the lack of proper planning and implementation.

Tux talks

Karan,

I read the comparison test of Linux distributions that was carried in the August issue. I remember Digit carrying a similar comparison a while back. I cannot see the point in these articles being repeated every few months and I attribute it to the fact that Digit is short of Linux fanatics! This is not enough to satiate the appetite of us Linux lovers who also happen to be Digit lovers.

I think that you are doing dis-service to this community because it gives the impression that there isn't much to write about actual applications.

I think that it is time you guys moved from the 'basic distribution comparison' phase to the 'what's under the hood' phase! Why don't you review applications like Abiword or StarOffice for Linux, and show people how to install/configure/tweak and finally use the software? Or show them how to connect to the net via the GUI and the console. There is a lot more that can be written about like networking, firewalls, network gaming, and a lot of other stuff that a Windows 98 machine and in some cases even an NT/2000 machine cannot do without additional application software.

IMTIAZ

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Imtiaz,

You are right. We have reduced the amount of stuff that we do on Linux in the magazine over the last year or so. But that has mostly to do with the fact that there don't seem to be enough Linux fanatics in India. As for reviews on applications such as Abiword and StarOffice for Linux, and workshops and other Insight articles on Gnome and networking, we have done these in the past.

The main reason for the lack of emphasis on Linux is that most of our readers feel that Linux is not for them. Until that changes, and we'd like to see this happen, our coverage of Linux will probably be limited.

Goof Ups

■ Sorry...we goofed. Nikhil's sharp eyes have spotted our mistake. Report card in the August issue of Digit carries a review of the Palm M105, but the picture alongside it is that of the Palm Vx.

■ Shauvik Chatterjee has pointed out that the correct URL of the company that has created Reason, the sound editing software featured in Test Drive in the August 2001 issue of Digit is www.propel.com

Notice any goof-ups? Write to goof@jasubhai.com

Send your letters marked 'Readers Letters' to the Digit office:

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Short Bytes

C for ?

Hi Digit,

I'm in a real fix! I've got a question I need help with: What is the full form of COMPUTER?! My teacher asks our class the same question every day and we are all speechless. Please send us the answer so that we can turn the tables on her for a change.

UDIT MADAN

Via e-mail

This is really embarrassing. None of us has a clue. Does anyone out there have any suggestions?

News in the mail

Hi Karan,

I think that Digit should start a newsletter service, which readers can register for, that automatically mails us information about the forthcoming issue of Digit.

BALACHANDAR

Via e-mail

Hot stuff

Dear Digit,

I am totally bowled over by the cool looks and editorial content of the new Digit. Do you guys have Glenn McGrath in your editorial team?

As the issue number increases, I can see that the magazine and CDs are getting cooler and cooler.

SANDEEP PRABHU

Via e-mail

What a shape!

Dear Sir,

I have a couple of ideas about how you can make Digit better. First, don't change the cover because that's really cool.

However, I do have a suggestion for the CD. All CDs kind of look the same, which is really boring. Why not make yours in the shape of fruits or something really unique?

RITESH AKHAURY

Via email

If you have suggestions on how to make Digit better, come participate in the reader survey at <http://www.thinkdigit.com/survey/betterdigit>